



# Simplifying SQLite Tasks Using AndroidWithoutStupid

Programming for mobile apps is not as easy it is for desktops/Web applications. And when it comes to database operations on the mobile, the going gets even tougher. For Android development, there is the **AndroidWithoutStupid** library, which promises to make CRUD tasks less of a hassle.

**S**QLite is an extremely robust database with a very light footprint. Because of this, it has easily become the most widely deployed database in the world. SQLite is natively supported on Android and is the default choice for most Android app developers.

Database operations have to be performed very carefully in Android, as mistakes can easily corrupt your app and cause its VM to be killed. Apart from that, database operations require several lines of code to get things right. In this article, you will learn how to avoid all the hassles by using the **AndroidWithoutStupid** Java Library. I will also present a few design considerations to make your database operations robust and efficient.

## AndroidWithoutStupid Java Library

Like SQLite, **AndroidWithoutStupid** is public domain software. You can use the code as it is or cut-and-paste whatever is required. I wrote this library because Android apps typically require a lot of apparently unnecessary and distracting fluff. For example, to show a simple message, you need to write the following:

```
Toast.makeText(
    getApplicationContext(),
    "Hello, World!",
    Toast.LENGTH_SHORT).show();
```

With **AndroidWithoutStupid**, you can use a one-liner

*MvMessages.showMessage()* method wherever you want, without much ado. Once initialised, the same *MvMessages* instance can be used to display notifications, menus, prompts and many other things.

```
// Initialization
MvMessages oink = new MvMessages(getApplicationContext());
...
// Wherever required
oink.showMessage("Hello, World!");
```

Similarly, **AndroidWithoutStupid** library has other classes to perform a variety of Android-related tasks - all requiring the least number of steps.

For database operations, **AndroidWithoutStupid** has the *MvSQLiteDB* class. You don't have to subclass *SQLiteOpenHelper*, parse *ContentValues* objects, or worry about known/unknown exceptions. No, siree! You create an *MvSQLiteDB* instance and start using SQL statements, similar to how you would do with desktop or Web applications. You don't even have to bother with opening or closing the database!

## Creating a new SQLite database

There are several constructors for the *MvSQLiteDB* class. To create a new SQLite database, you need to initialise the class with the path for the database file and the table definition statements, as follows: